You've created a couple of filters now, so we should look at how to use them in the application. In the next section we'll tackle two specific issues: how to control which requests execute your new filters and how to control the order in which they execute.

21.5 Adding filters to your actions and Razor Pages

In section 21.3 I discussed the similarities and differences between middleware and filters. One of those differences is that filters can be scoped to specific actions or controllers so that they run only for certain requests. Alternatively, you can apply a filter globally so that it runs for every MVC action and Razor Page.

By adding filters in different ways, you can achieve several different results. Imagine you have a filter that forces you to log in to execute an action. How you add the filter to your app will significantly change your app's behavior:

- *Apply the filter to a single action or Razor Page.* Anonymous users could browse the app as normal, but if they tried to access the protected action or Razor Page, they would be forced to log in.
- *Apply the filter to a controller.* Anonymous users could access actions from other controllers, but accessing any action on the protected controller would force them to log in.
- *Apply the filter globally.* Users couldn't use the app without logging in. Any attempt to access an action or Razor Page would redirect the user to the login page.